

Eunah Jeong

Motivation Letter & Research Statement

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Dear ETH SSRF Program Committee,

My motivation stems from an enduring curiosity to learn and to push the boundaries of both cognitive and physical capability. I have come to value learning as a deeply creative act through my Foundation Visual Arts certificate, 3D & Game Design diploma, experiences working as a designer, and exploration of diverse disciplines, from theoretical studies to embodied skills such as piano, sketching, sewing, and ballet. Yet I often found myself alone in this pursuit, surrounded by indifference toward curiosity and growth. This solitude led me to robotics, where I see the potential for intelligent, collaborative systems to share the joy of learning and creation that I sought among people.

Ultimately, my vision is to develop robots that not only act intelligently but also embody enthusiasm and creativity, enabled by the power of cooperation, transforming how we learn, work, and create together.

My most memorable experiences are from two long-term projects on [video](#) and [game](#) production. I directed these projects, which required diverse skills, including lighting, audio, cinematography, 3D modeling, as well as UI/UX, environment building, and simulation in Unreal Engine. Now, with a Computer Science B.Sc. and greater exposure to research through my ongoing B.E. program, I am intrigued by how robots can be educated efficiently in simulated environments just like those I used for the game project.

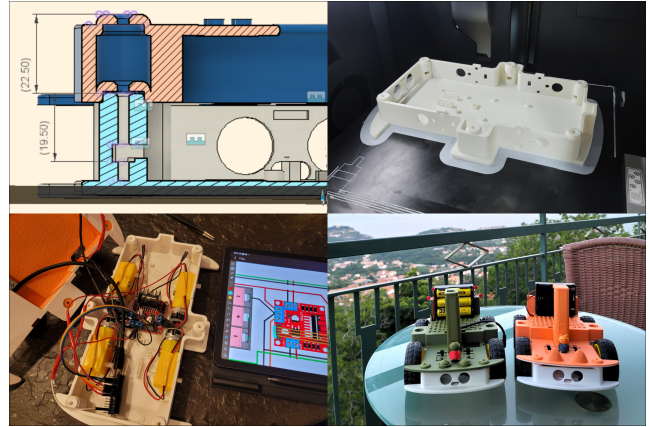
The strong focus on simulation in Prof. Stelian Coros's group captivates my curiosity. His [RoboLaunch talk](#) deepened my knowledge in using simulation for robot learning, a passion initially sparked by exploring [the work of Vladlen Koltun](#). Prof. Coros's reasoning on why simulation is powerful for manipulation tasks and his vision of improving robots' mechanical design through simulation were deeply thought-provoking. His work on safety through domain randomization ([As et al., 2025](#)) also caught my attention.

Attending the [CoRL 2025 Data Workshop](#) affirmed my research orientation: I am more drawn to approaches that integrate principled models with learning, rather than relying solely on large volumes of real data to discover patterns. It also made me realize the importance of strengthening both my theoretical foundation and hands-on experimentation to build the skills necessary for advancing robotics. To this end, I have assembled an [OpenBot Fleet](#) ([Müller et al., 2024](#)) and explored [generalist policies](#) for robot learning.

I believe that the research environment led by Prof. Coros offers the ideal setting for me to develop these capabilities further and define my path as a researcher. By bringing my unique perspective as a ever-curious learner and learning enthusiast to ETH's collaborative research community, I hope to contribute to the ongoing effort toward a society where humans and robots learn and coexist meaningfully.

Thank you for considering my application.

Eunah Jeong



OpenBot Assembly. I have modeled, 3D printed, built, and operated these low-cost robots.